

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting property disputes, client-facing legal advice and case management at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, prepared hearing bundles, reviewed leasehold and landlord and tenant matters, and maintained matter records across competing deadlines. At Citizens Advice, manages housing, welfare and debt matters from instruction to submission, advising clients clearly on procedural requirements. Strong document management, deadline tracking and client communication skills, with a developing interest in residential property work.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages housing, welfare benefits, debt and consumer matters from instruction to submission: takes detailed client statements, identifies legal and evidential issues, drafts correspondence and applications, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex statutory rules into clear, practical guidance for individuals often unfamiliar with legal processes
- Assesses eligibility for Universal Credit, Housing Benefit and related support against statutory criteria; identifies evidential gaps; researches complex legal points

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across leasehold, landlord and tenant, rights of light and easement matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Conducted legal and factual research on residential and commercial property issues; prepared client notes

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories

- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the sole junior on the team shortly before a significant deadline, helping ensure on-time submission
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; met client and supervisor deadlines

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter record maintenance, deadline tracking, case-file organisation, document review across high-volume matters